The life of a task

Every state, every branch, start to end

Shah Investors Home Limited

One task was driven through every branch on a running system to produce this guide — accepted, started, blocked, unblocked, sent for review, rejected, reworked, completed, verified and closed. The screens are that task, in order, and the last page is the trail it left.

The diagram overleaf and the table at the back are generated from the application's own state machine, not drawn by hand. If a move is not on them, the software refuses it.

WHAT IS IN HERE

The whole picture — one diagram

START

1. The task arrives

DOING THE WORK

2. In progress
3. When it is waiting on somebody else
4. Blocked, and back again

CHECKING

5. Sent for review
6. Sent back

FINISHING

7. Completed, then verified
8. Closed

THE RECORD

9. What it leaves behind

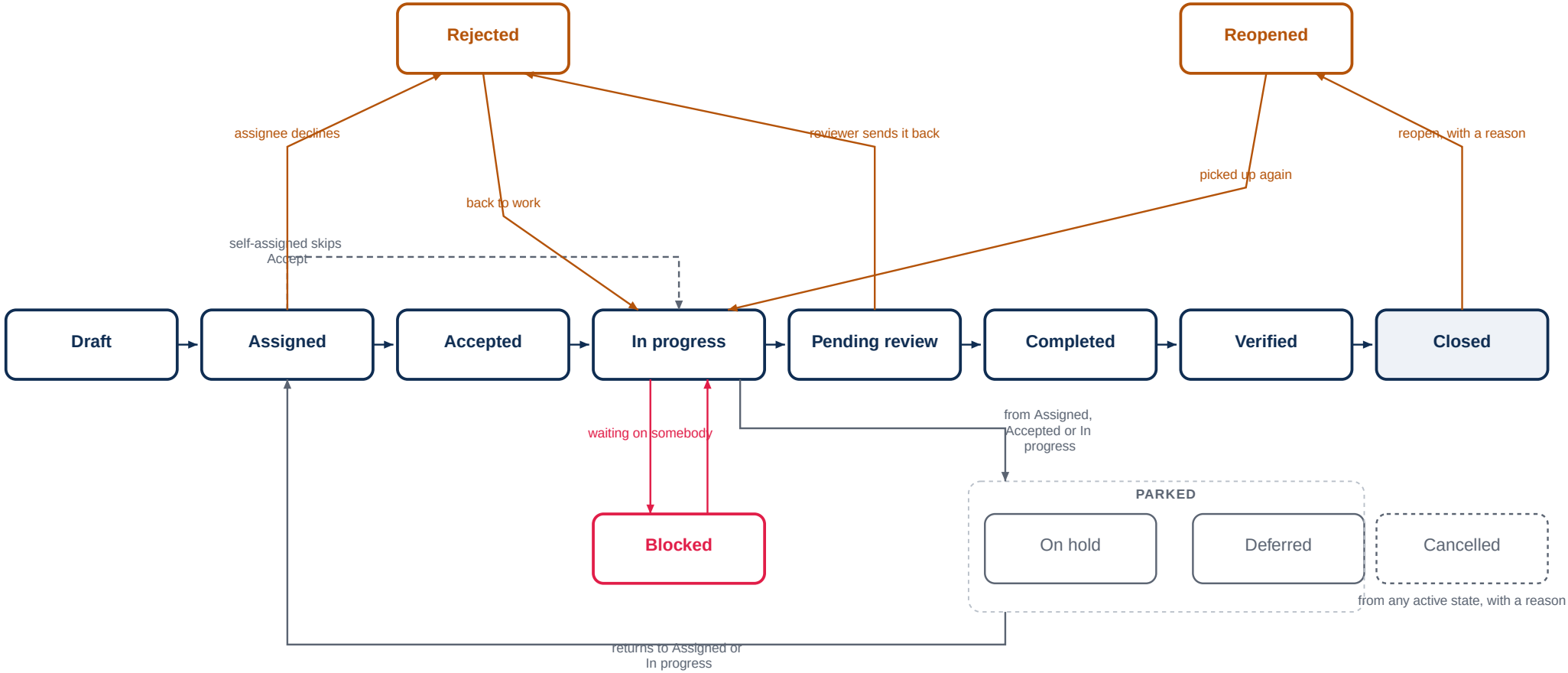
REFERENCE

Every legal move, in full

THE WHOLE PICTURE

A task, from raised to closed

The dark line is the path most work takes. Everything else is a branch that exists because real work takes it. Drawn from the application's own state machine — if a move is not on this page, the software refuses it.



THE CLOCK

The SLA clock pauses in Blocked and On hold. Time spent waiting on somebody else is outside the assignee's control and never counts against them — that one rule is what keeps the timeliness figure fair.

A REASON IS REQUIRED FOR

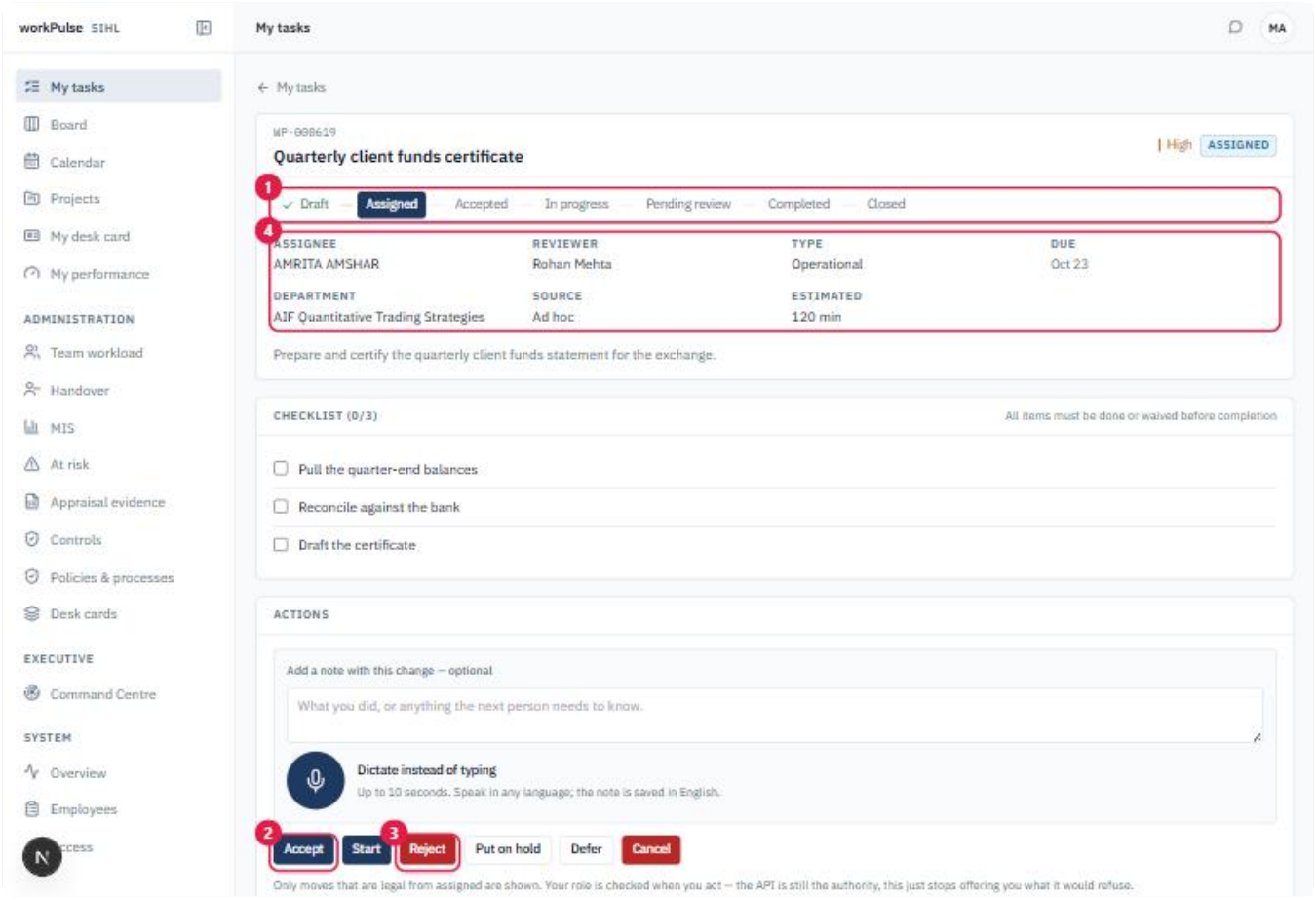
Rejected · Reopened · Cancelled · Blocked · On hold · Deferred. Each of these asserts something about another person's work or availability, and an unexplained one is useless to whoever receives it.

Screens here were captured on 18-19 October. The interface has moved on in one visible way since: the sidebar has gained SLA targets. Everything else in these pictures still matches the application.

START

1. The task arrives

Work reaches somebody in one of two ways: generated from an approved desk card activity on its schedule, or raised by hand. Either way it lands in Assigned, and nothing has happened yet.



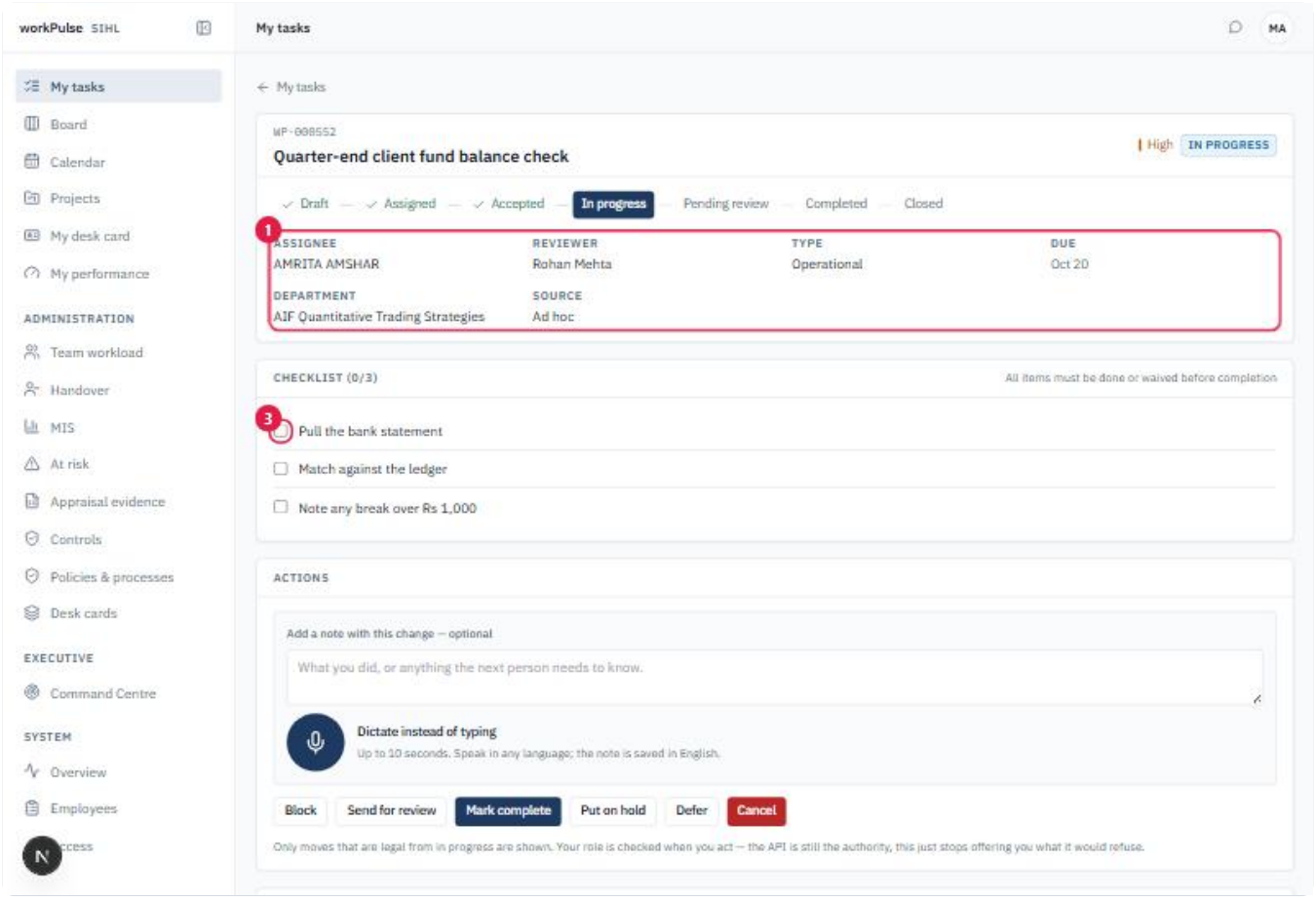
1. Where it is. Every state it has passed through is ticked; the current one is filled.
2. Accept — the assignee says it is theirs. Start goes straight to work for self-assigned tasks, where there is nobody to accept it from.
3. Reject — the assignee declines it, with a reason. It goes back for somebody to reassign.
4. Who it is for, who checks it, when it is due, and whether it came from a desk card.

> *Only the moves that are legal from the current state are shown. Your role is checked again when you act — the screen is a convenience, the API is the authority.*

DOING THE WORK

2. In progress

Accepting then starting puts the task In progress. This is where almost all of its life is spent.



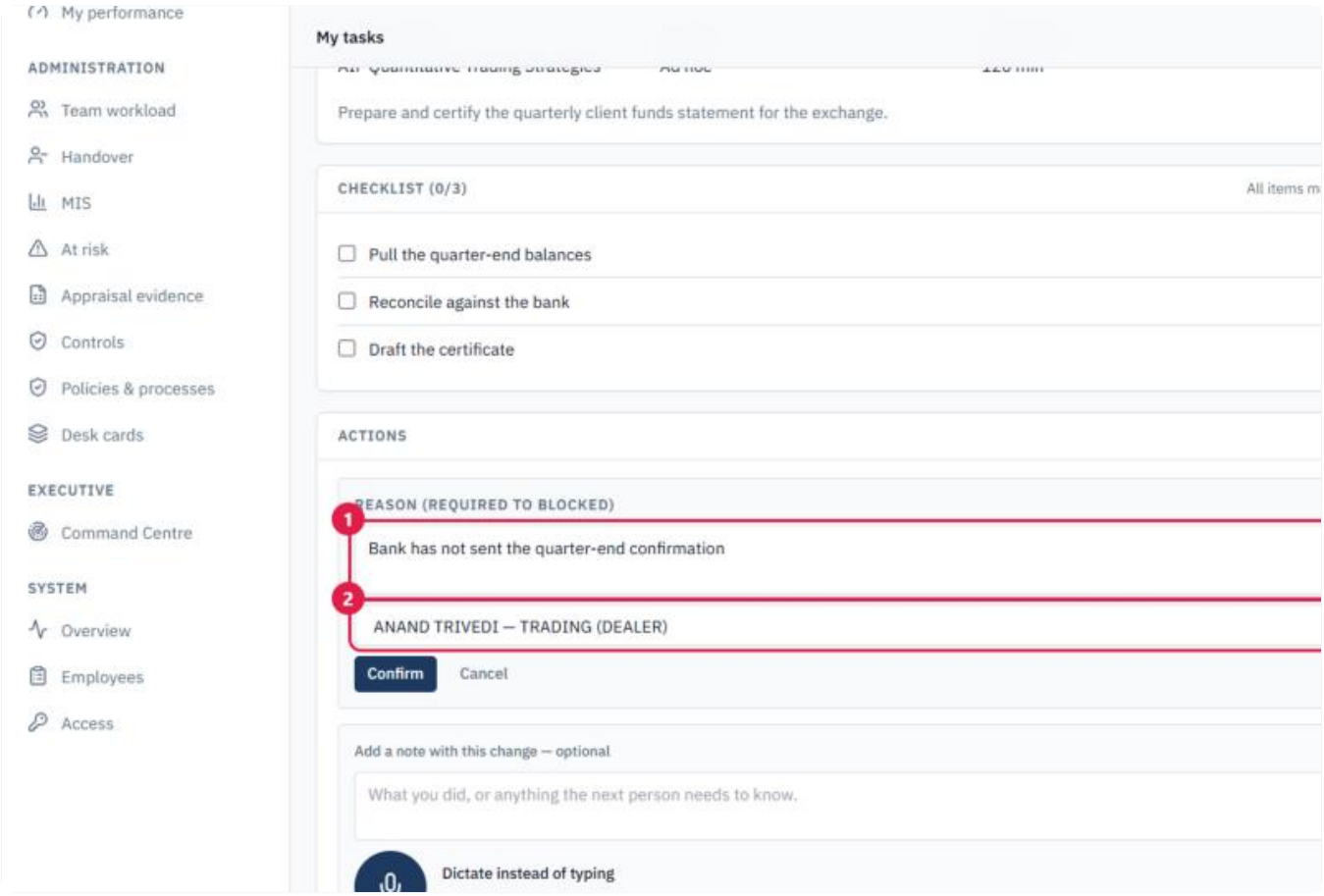
1. The facts, unchanged since it arrived unless a manager corrected them.
2. The checklist. Every item must be ticked or explicitly waived before the work can be completed.
3. Each item, ticked by whoever does the work.

> *Evidence can be added at any point: a file, a note, or the ticked checklist. Any one of them is enough to keep the closure off the anti-gaming report.*

DOING THE WORK

3. When it is waiting on somebody else

Blocking is not a way of parking something you would rather not do. It says: this cannot proceed until a named person does something.



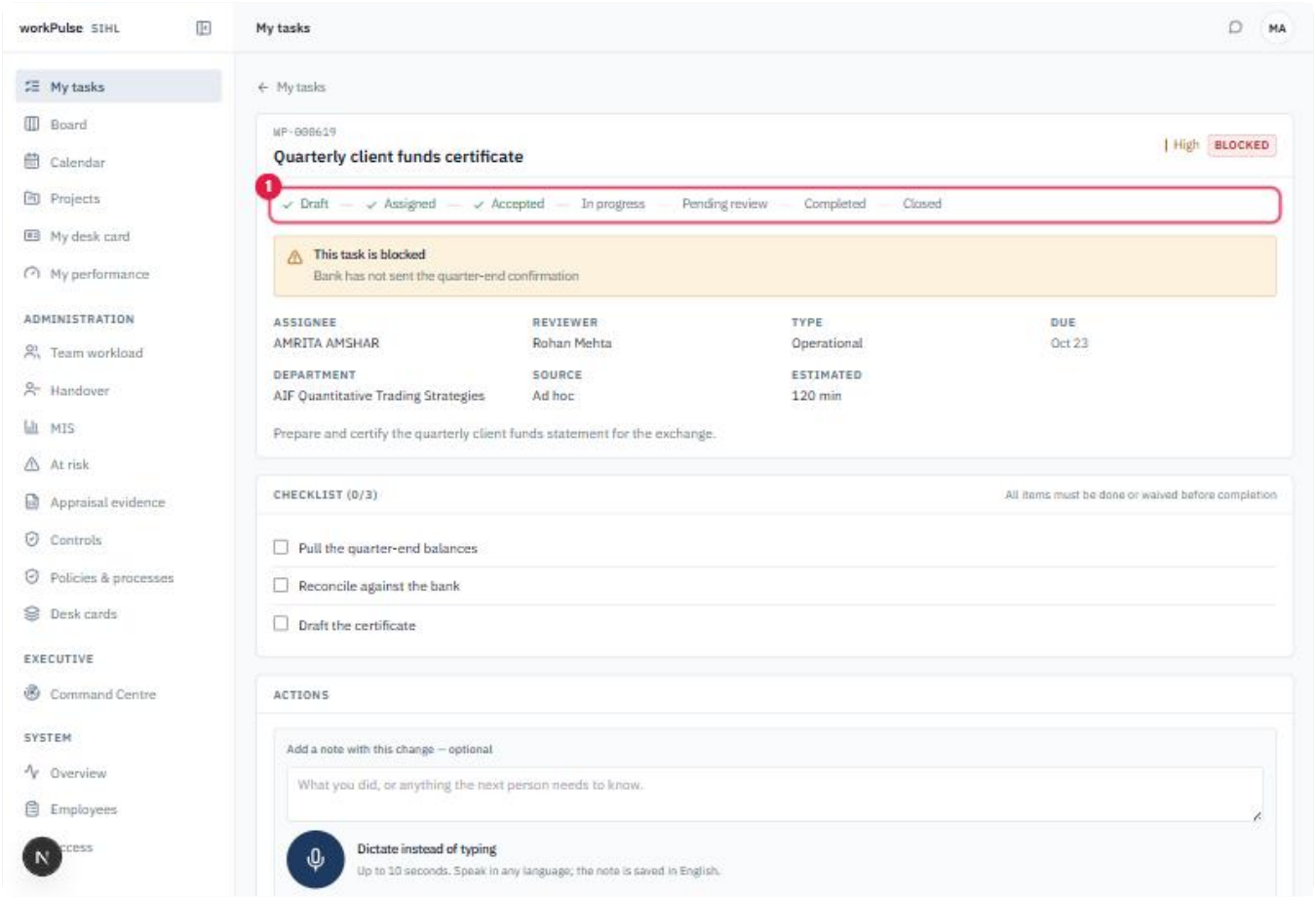
1. Why it is blocked. Required — the reason is what the person unblocking it reads.
2. Who owns unblocking it. Also required: a block with nobody against it is a task nobody will chase.
3. Confirm.

> *The SLA clock stops while a task is blocked. That is the point of recording it properly: the delay belongs to whoever caused it, not to the person holding the task.*

DOING THE WORK

4. Blocked, and back again

A blocked task is visible as blocked — on the board, on the team workload screen, and to whoever owns clearing it.



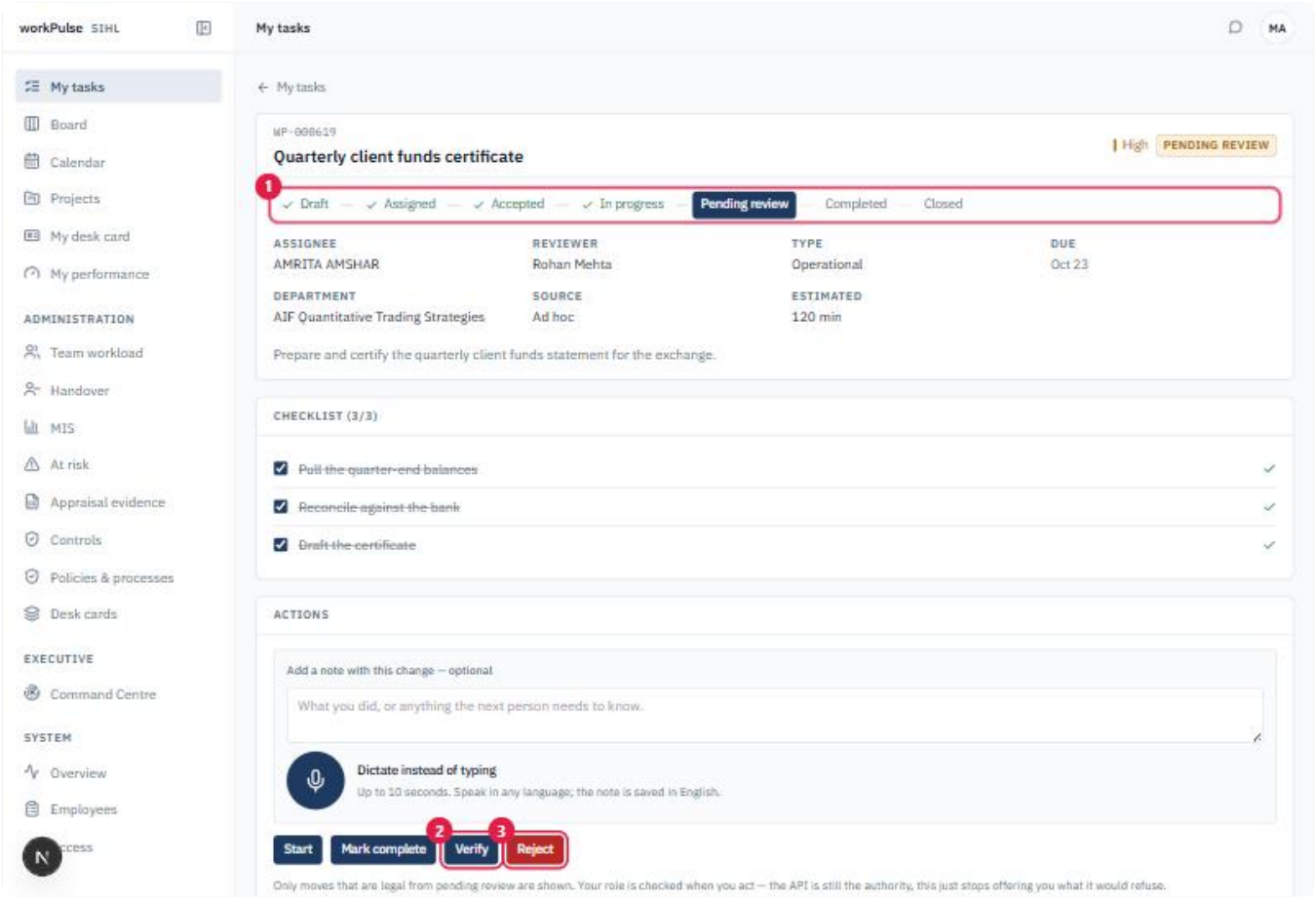
1 The banner carries the reason, so nobody has to open the history to find out what is waiting.

Blocked is a round trip, not a dead end: the only way out is back to In progress, or cancellation. It cannot be completed from here, which stops a blocked task being quietly closed to tidy a list.

CHECKING

5. Sent for review

When the work is done, the assignee sends it to the named reviewer. A task with no reviewer cannot be sent at all — a manager assigns one first.



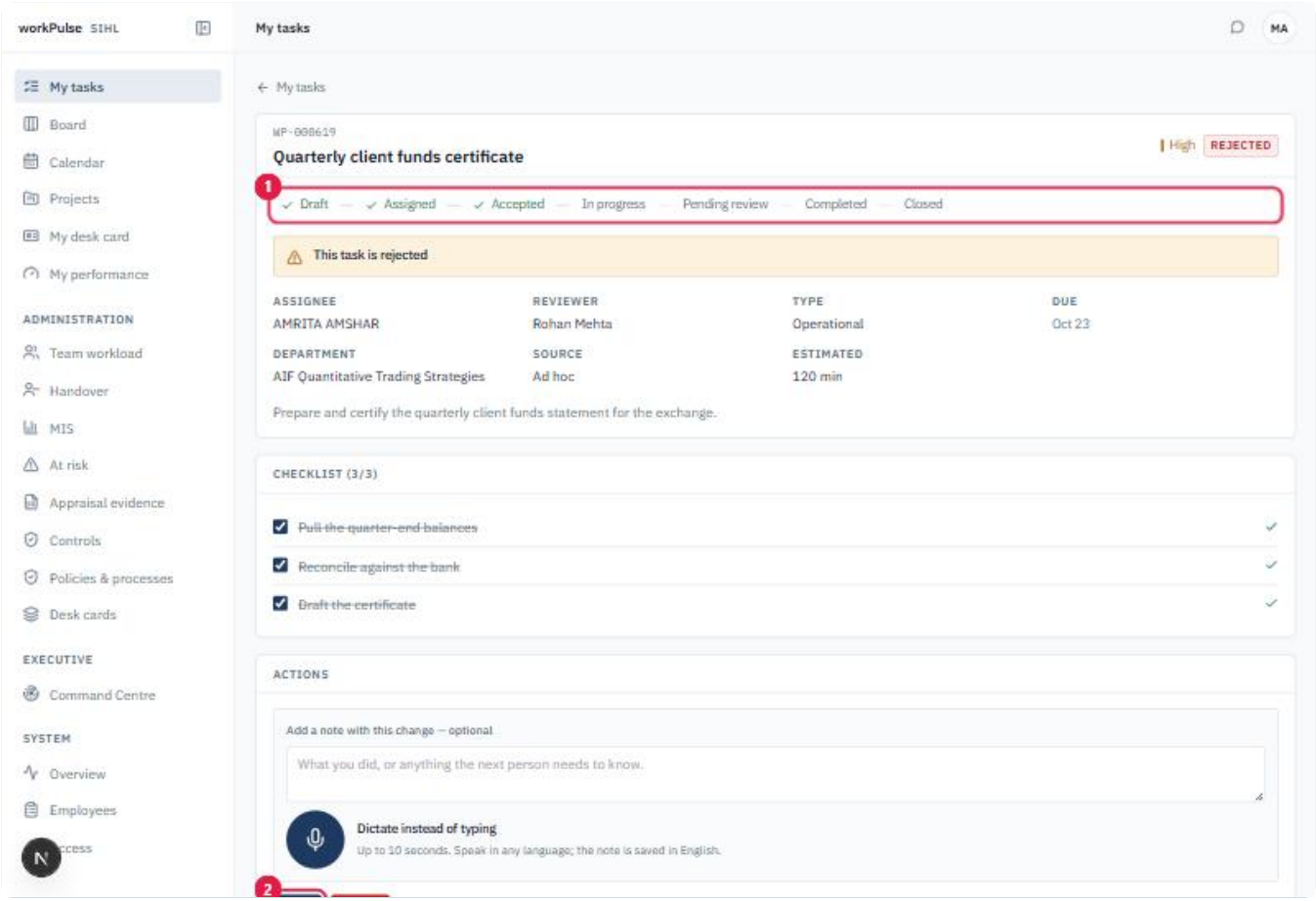
1. The checklist is complete; that is a precondition of leaving In progress.
2. Verify — the reviewer is satisfied.
3. Reject — it goes back, with a reason.

> *Nobody can verify their own work, under any role, including a system administrator. If the assignee and the reviewer are the same person, the system refuses — and it is right to.*

CHECKING

6. Sent back

Rejection is a normal outcome, not a failure of the system. What matters is that the reason travels with it.



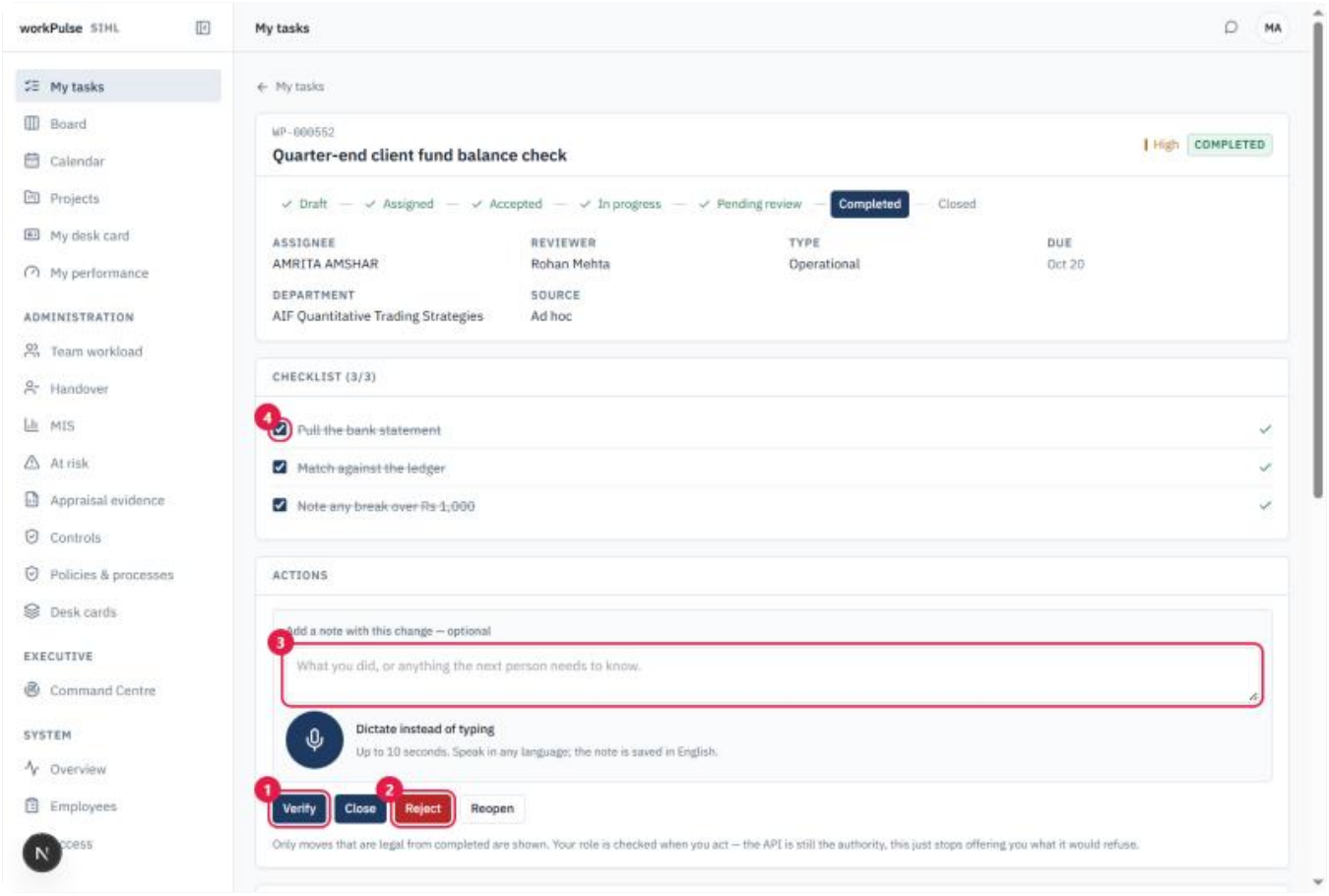
1 The banner says it was rejected; the reason is in the history immediately below, in the reviewer's own words.

From here the task goes back to In progress and round the loop again. Each pass is recorded separately, so a task rejected three times looks different from one that went through cleanly — which is a fact about the process, not an accusation about the person.

FINISHING

7. Completed, then verified

Completed, Verified and Closed are three different things, and collapsing them would lose the distinction the whole system rests on.



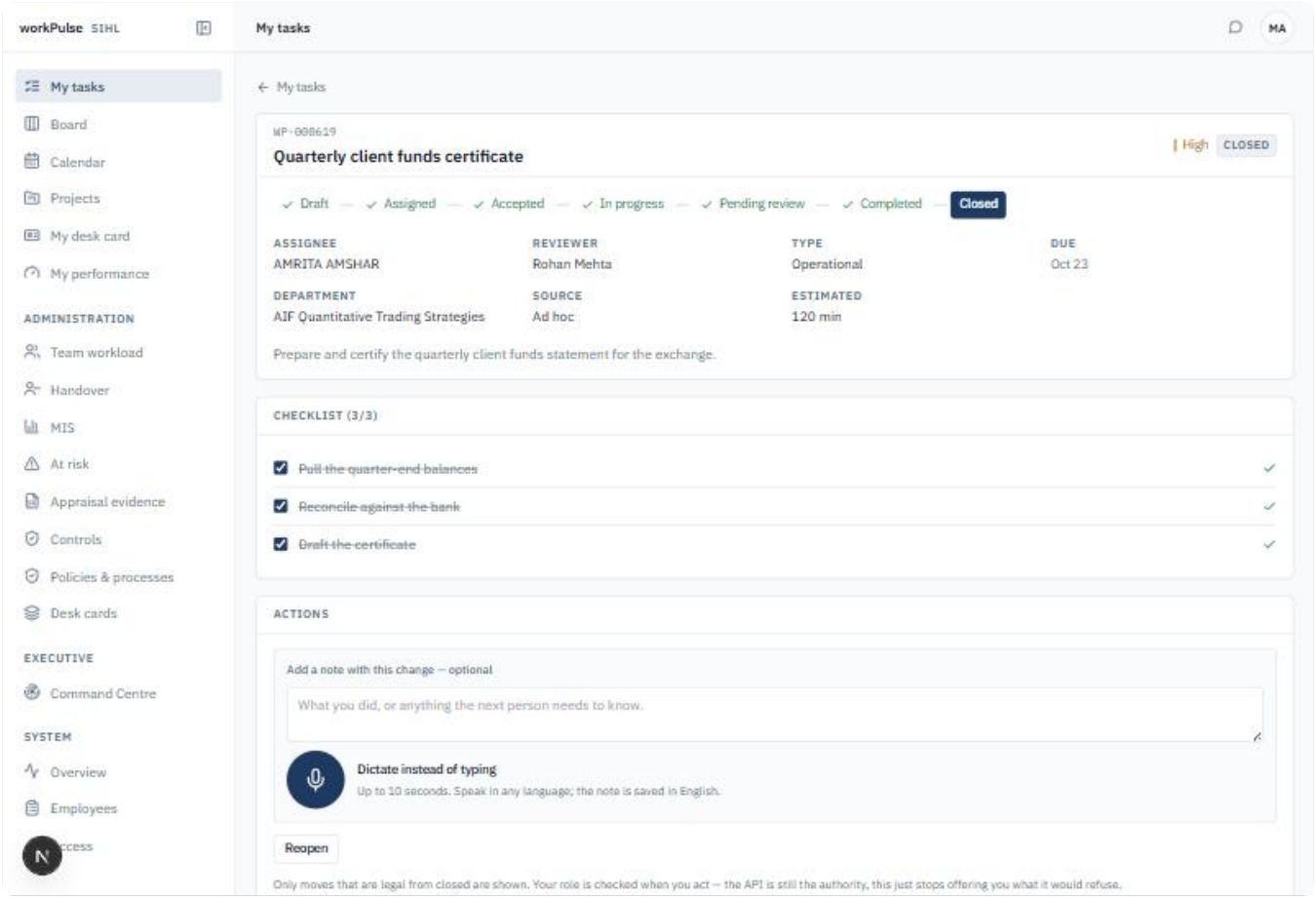
1. Verify — a second person confirms it meets the requirement.
2. Reject — still available at this point.
3. A note, which is what an auditor reads alongside the dates.
4. The completed checklist, kept as it was ticked.

> *Completed is the assignee asserting the work is done. Verified is somebody else confirming it. Closed is the formal end. Task types that do not require verification close after a grace period instead.*

FINISHING

8. Closed

The end of the line. Every state is ticked and the only move left is to reopen it.



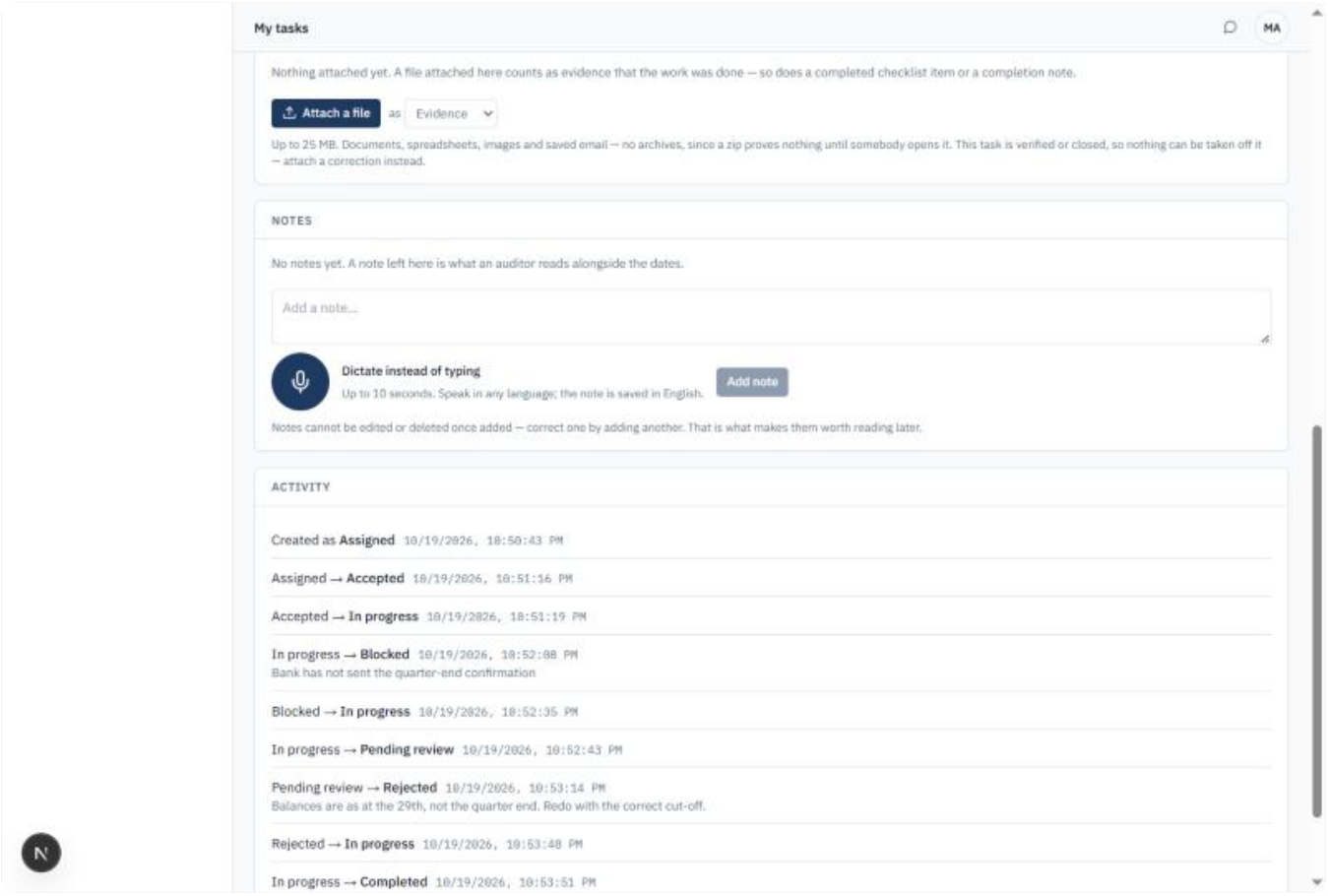
1. Reopen — available, audited, and reported. Reopening after closure is one of the things the anti-gaming view looks at, because it is how a premature closure gets corrected.

> *A closed task takes no further edits except comments and attachments. Its figures are now part of the period they fall in.*

THE RECORD

9. What it leaves behind

Every move, with who made it, when, and — where the rules demand one — why. This is the same task from the previous eight pages.



1 The whole journey in order: assigned, accepted, started, blocked with its reason, unblocked, sent for review, rejected with the reviewer's reason, back to work, completed, verified, closed.

This is what makes the rest defensible. A figure in MIS or on somebody's appraisal evidence can always be traced back to a specific move by a specific person at a specific time — and to the reason they gave for it.

REFERENCE

Every legal move, in full

Read straight out of the application's state machine. Anything absent from this table is refused — not hidden, refused, with a message saying so.

FROM	CAN MOVE TO
Draft	Assigned, Cancelled *
Assigned	Accepted, Rejected *, In progress, Cancelled *, On hold *, Deferred *
Accepted	In progress, Blocked *, Cancelled *, On hold *, Deferred *
In progress	Blocked *, Pending review, Completed, Cancelled *, On hold *, Deferred *
Blocked	In progress, Cancelled *, On hold *
Pending review	Completed, Verified, Rejected *, In progress
Completed	Verified, Closed, Rejected *, Reopened *
Verified	Closed, Reopened *
Closed	Reopened *
Rejected	Assigned, In progress, Cancelled *
Reopened	In progress, Assigned, Cancelled *
Cancelled	— terminal, nothing follows
On hold	In progress, Assigned, Cancelled *
Deferred	Assigned, In progress, Cancelled *

** a reason is required to make this move. States shown in amber are the ones a task cannot be put into silently.*